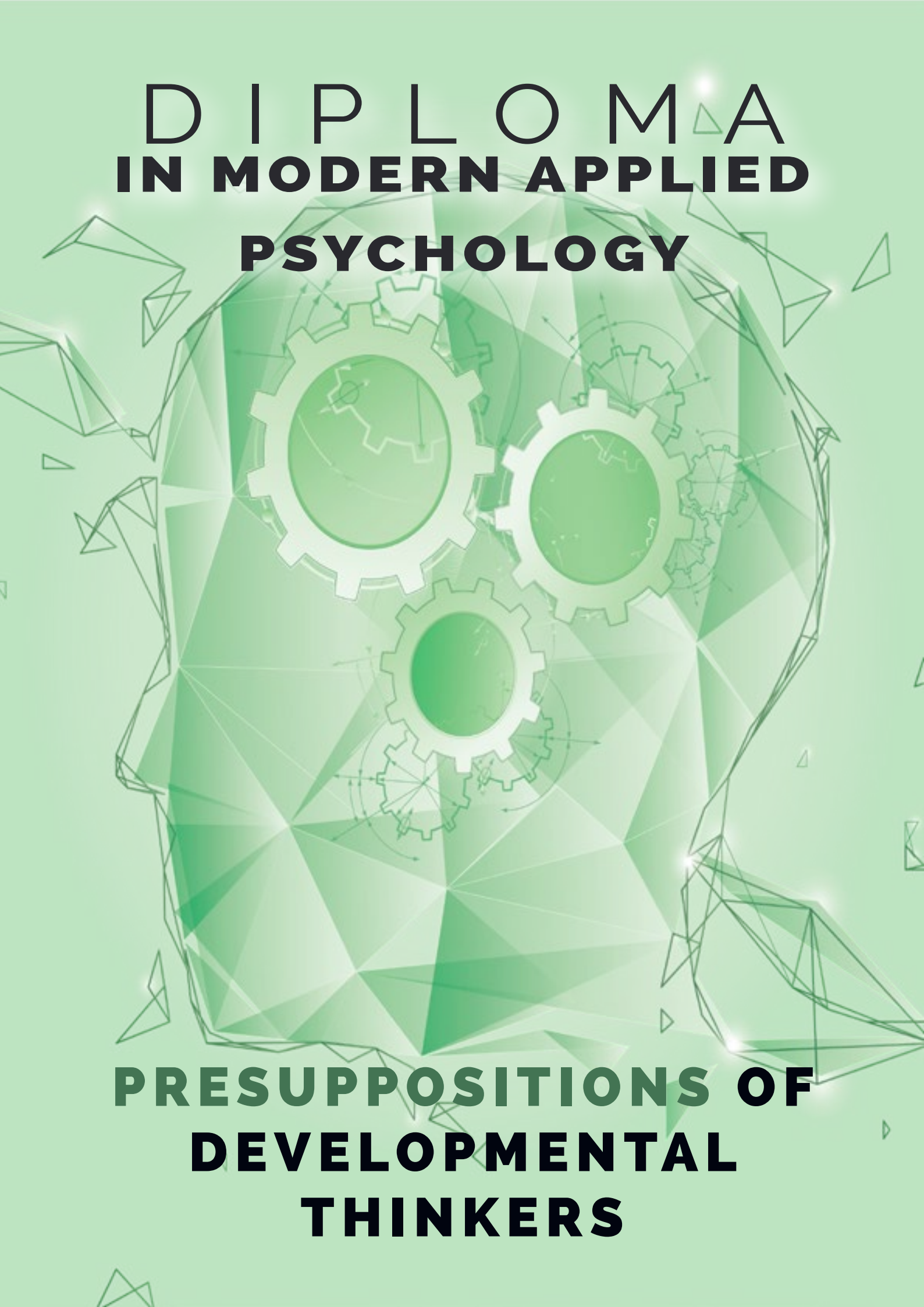


DIPLOMA IN MODERN APPLIED PSYCHOLOGY

The background is a vibrant green with a complex, low-poly geometric pattern. Overlaid on this are several interlocking gears of different sizes, some in white and some in a darker green. Thin, light green lines and arrows crisscross the background, suggesting a network or a system of interconnected parts. The overall aesthetic is modern and technological.

**PRESUPPOSITIONS OF
DEVELOPMENTAL
THINKERS**

PRESUPPOSITIONS OF DEVELOPMENTAL THINKERS

Presuppositions determine the attitude we have towards people in life; they give form to the underlying beliefs and attitudes that people work and live their lives by. Your presuppositions dictate, on an unconscious level, how you respond to the world; how you handle the news, relationships, circumstances and change.

The following are healthy presuppositions which will enable us to connect with others in the most effective and beneficial way. Presuppositions are not universal facts, they're just attitudes which we can assign to our relationships in order to make them less judgemental and more accepting.

1. People are processors of experience rather than passive victims of circumstance. Everyone can change when they're ready to.

This presupposition undermines many of the ideas promoted by formal psychology institutes and organisations which diagnose people with mental health conditions in a manner which implies these diagnoses are permanent or unchangeable. When people see themselves as a victim of circumstance, they allow themselves to become crushed by their own story. People are not their experiences, mental health conditions, behaviours, personality traits or roles. Everyone has the ability to be the person they want to be; they are capable of developing and outgrowing their current and past circumstance

2. People are not broken entities who need to be fixed, they just need to be understood. All people can learn to be better communicators.

The quality of our lives is influenced by the relationships we keep, and the quality of the relationships we keep is determined by the quality of our communications. Perceptions are not always reality; if you not communicating well with others, or with yourself, about your perceptions, then it's likely that your relationships will become negatively impacted by false or mis-informed ideas.

3. If people learn unhelpful ways of thinking, they can also unlearn them equally as fast. Everyone can develop a growth-driven mindset.

Our current worldviews, opinions and outlooks on life developed out of our past experiences. However, as we haven't experienced all that there is to experience in our lifetimes, we will develop new perspectives and new ways of seeing things. Just because we learned certain unhelpful habits of thinking doesn't mean we're destined to hold onto these thoughts forever; we only do so if we choose to do so.

4. Every person is solely responsible for the thoughts, feelings, actions and behaviour. It is taking responsibility which breeds empowerment.

We cannot grow and change in an area of our life which we have not owned. As we have stated a hundred times before, responsibility breeds empowerment. No one will own our problems for us; we have to accept that nearly everything we struggle with is within our power to change and no one else's, and if it's not within our power to change, it's within our power to change our attitude towards.



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5. We can't control thoughts entering our mind, but we can choose to act upon them or not. We're only one thought away from a new way of seeing things.

How many people do you know just act upon the thoughts which pop into their mind? We've all made mistakes in life, we've said and done things we didn't mean or regretted later. We see bad acts and immediately judge other people for what they have said or done, but resent it when people blacklist us in the same way. Whilst we should not be open to condoning and ignoring bad behaviour, we must accept that we can never know the nuances and intricacies of a person's mind and, therefore, should not judge or label people according to our perceptions of them, no matter how much we disapprove of what they've done.

The same goes for our internal dialogues. We've all subjected ourselves to harsh self-chastisement, embarrassment and belittlement thanks to negative thoughts and cruel inner critics. Whilst these negative statements may seem to us as 'objective truths', we have to learn to accept that they are entirely subjective and that no one is forcing us to believe in them: only we are.

6. All people have the ability to choose a new set of habits, thought patterns and behaviours. Anyone can learn anything with a desire and the right strategy.

We must always give people the benefit of the doubt in life, including ourselves. We all have the power to choose new behaviours, ways of thinking and habits provided we allow ourselves to. It's very easy to stick to a routine and a way of thinking because it's easier to stay as you are than change, but nothing worthy in life comes easy.

7. The meaning of our communications is determined by other people, not by us. We must observe others to gauge the calibre of our communications.

We must strive to mean what we say and say what we mean in life. We can't control how people interpret us, but the more effort we put into clarifying and simplifying our communications, the more chance we have of ensuring that we have communicated ourselves to the best of our ability. If people still misinterpret what we said, who we are and what we stand for, we can at least know we tried our best.

Q1. Which presuppositions did you find the most challenging to accept and why?

Q2. Which presuppositions did you find easiest to accept and why?



PRESUPPOSITIONS OF DEVELOPMENTAL THINKERS

Q3. How do you intend to challenge yourself to accept presuppositions which you find hard to accept? What do you fear would happen if you embrace and accept certain presuppositions?

